



AP 2-D Art and Design Portfolio

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Written Evidence

Sustained Investigation

Identify the inquiry that guided your sustained investigation.

Response:

My S.I. question is "How does the intent of living in the present moment allow me to discover the beauty of nature, order and chaos, spark my imagination and prompt me seek the meaning of life?" I believe that the present moment carries abundant richness that we often overlook. This question grows from my curiosity, and experience of time in nature when I see beauty and chaos intertwined. It allows me to experiment with three different dimensions—nature, imagination, and reflection of life—while still tying them all together through the central theme of "the present is a present".

Describe ways your sustained investigation developed through practice, experimentation, and revision.

Response:

At first I tried to use photography to capture the moment. But later on, I realized how combining photography with different medias of traditional arts, such as acrylic, water color, and even cardboard, yarns and calligraphy, adds more dimensions and ways how I can convey ideas of living in the present. I started to tear out photos(8), use photo as references(4) or part of elements of design(3). For example, in work 6, I found color pencil best represent the present as it gives fine details; watercolor best represent the past, youth, abstract; saturated acrylic is best for the colorful future.



Image 1

Sustained Investigation

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Materials: Photography, Mac photo edit

Process(es):

Use golden ratio spiral composition,
experiment with light and shadows of
leaves, shoot and edit

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used:

Apple Photos on Macbook

Image 2

Sustained Investigation

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Materials: water color

Process(es):

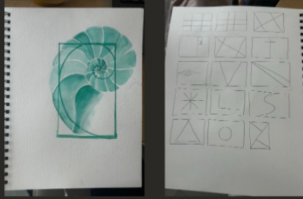
process for work 1; Experiment how light and shadows behind leaves interact to create harmony&peace

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

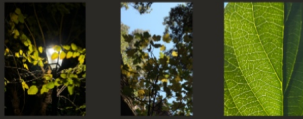
Digital Tool(s) used:

Apple photos on Mac

Composition brainstorming/ planning



Experimenting with light and shadows of leaves



Although I didn't intentionally planned the shoot of this photo(it was an accident), before I took this photo, I experimented with many photos of leaves behind a light source and tried to observe how light and shadows react to create harmony, peace in a composition.



I have heard popular saying on the internet, "Trees do not talk, but they listen". This saying alonged with my long belief that trees, although like actual, vivid being as us who can sense everything around, can never "talk", or express to the surroundings about their thoughts, feelings. However, this following moment upheld my belief. When I turned my view up side down and try to observe from the bottom, it amazed me. Its spiraling stem, with perfect golden ratio, dancing, breathing, and reaching towards the sun, like faint ripples. Didn't they say that trees do not talk? Photography, in a different perspective, offers me this chance to capture the whisper of nature's beauty while I was living in the present moment.

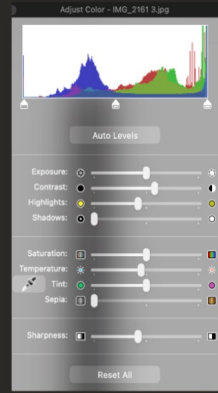




Image 3

Sustained Investigation

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Materials: Photography, Photoshop

Process(es):

captures 2 photos, compose and layer them in PS, sketch curved text to show flow of river and time

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used: Photoshop



Image 4

Sustained Investigation

Height: 12

Width: 9

Materials: water color, acrylic

Process(es):

Inspiration from photos I took, compose, sketch, coloring

Use of Digital Tool(s): No

Image 5

Sustained Investigation

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Materials: water color, acrylic

Process(es):

Inspiration from photos I took, compose, sketch, coloring, process photo for work

4

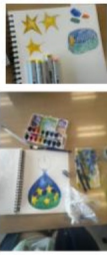
Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Inspiration
Picture of Dance I
by French artist
Henri Matisse,
took by student at
MOMA museum,
NY



Sketching,
coloring,
experimenting



Inspiration photos took
by me



Image 6

Sustained Investigation

Height: 12

Width: 9

Materials:

mixed media paper, color pencil paper,
acrylic, color pencils, water color, ink

Process(es):

observe maple seeds falling motions,
use different medias to color 3 stages of
the seed, calligraphy

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Image 7

Sustained Investigation

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Materials:

mixed media paper, color pencil paper, acrylic, color pencils, water color, ink

Process(es):

process and inspiration photo for 6

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



From Disney, Soul



Practicing and observing motion of maple seed



Practice using color pencil to show the details and textures



compose



Image 8

Sustained Investigation

Height: 12

Width: 18

Materials: photography, water color

Process(es):

Diagonal composition, tear out photo, use watercolor to blend the picture from grayscale to saturate.

Use of Digital Tool(s): No

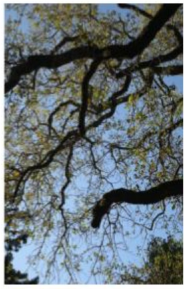


Photo shoot by me



Water color flow
experimenting



sketch



Inspiration from The
Creation From Adam

Image 9

Sustained Investigation

Height: 12

Width: 18

Materials: photography, water color

Process(es): process photo for work 8

Use of Digital Tool(s): No

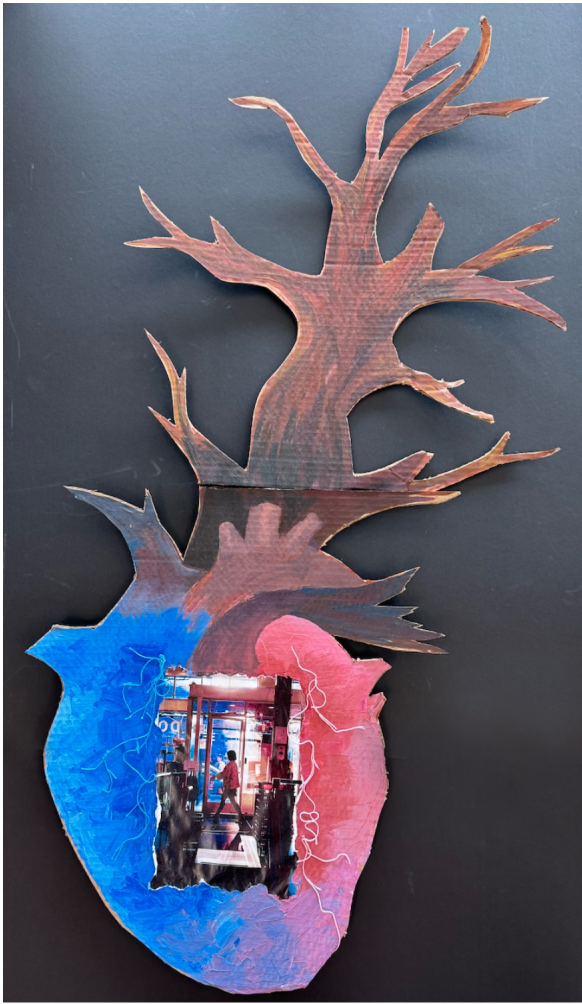


Image 10

Sustained Investigation

Height: 46

Width: 25

Materials:

photography, cardboard, acrylics, and
yarns

Process(es):

Photographing, editing, print out the
photo; draw and blend the picture in; cut
out the cardboard.

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used: Apple photos edit

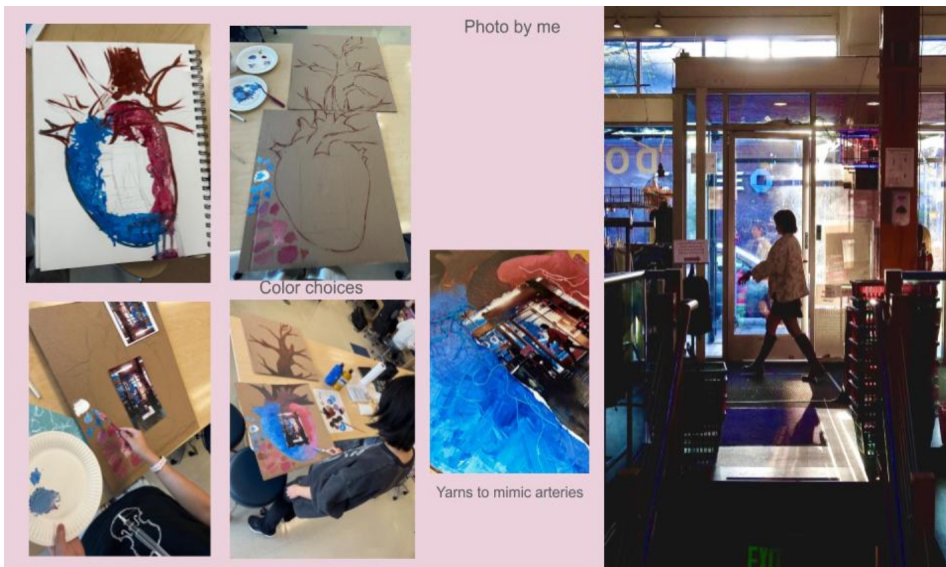


Image 11

Sustained Investigation

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Materials:

photography, cardboard, acrylics, yarns

Process(es): process for work 10

Use of Digital Tool(s): No

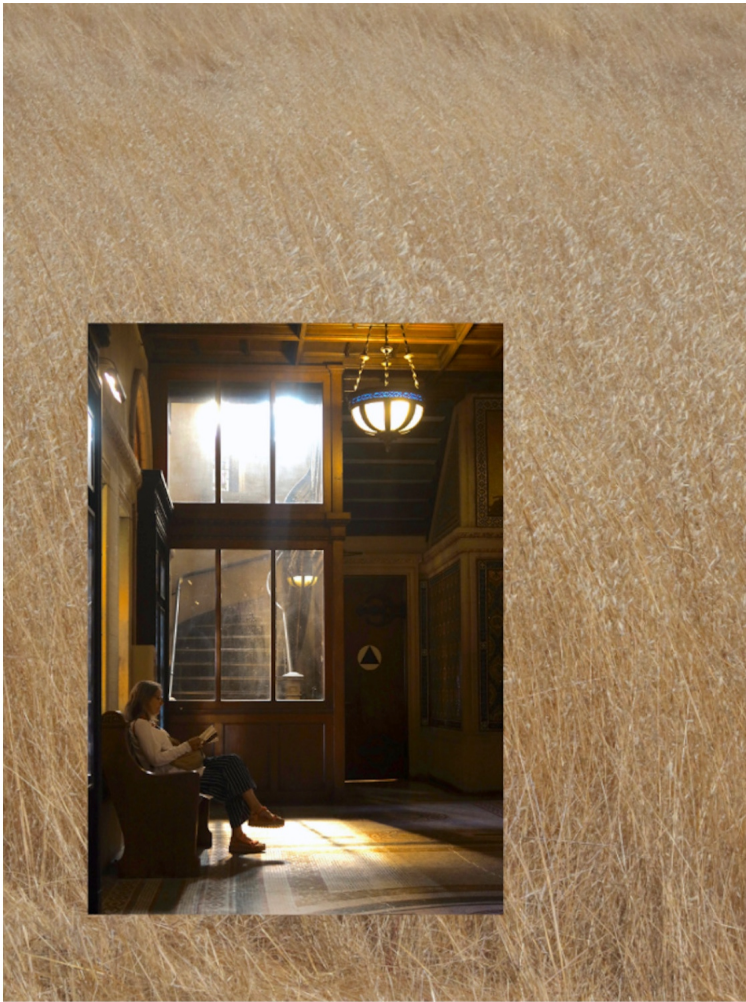


Image 12

Sustained Investigation

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Materials: Photography, Photoshop

Process(es):

Photographing, layer and reorient pictures to show how present moment of nature sparks imagination

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used: Photoshop



Image 13

Sustained Investigation

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Materials: Photography, Photoshop

Process(es): process for work 12

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used: Photoshop



Image 14

Sustained Investigation

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Depth: N/A

Materials: Photography

Process(es):

Experiment with different compositions;

Monotoned photo in PS to emphasize
peace of present moment

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used: Photoshop



Image 15

Sustained Investigation

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Materials: photography

Process(es):

Experiment using slow shutter speed to convey sense of time passing and beauty of the present moment

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Work 1

Selected Works

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Idea(s):

The vibrant red and blue light at that present moment intertwines&sparks my imagination of a heart.

Materials: photography

Process(es):

Diagonal composition; Capture contrasting color and lightning; Crop, adjust contrast, saturation.

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used: Apple Photo



Work 2

Selected Works

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Idea(s):

My grandma's wrinkles and eyes remind me of the crescent moon.

Natural, hopeful, loving, hardworking.

Materials: photography

Process(es):

Emphasize the natural wrinkles lines, sweat, texture of skin as elements of design.

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Work 3

Selected Works

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Idea(s):

The weathered metal door and cat we adopted, inspire me to show the course but simple life in rural.

Materials: photography

Process(es):

Use textured metal door, negative space, color contrast to present the original life in rural.

Use of Digital Tool(s):



Work 4

Selected Works

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Idea(s):

The extension line of fishing rod, the old man, the lines between sky&sea convey peace and solitude.

Materials: photography

Process(es):

Experiment with different compositions;

Monotoned photo in PS to emphasize

peace of present moment.

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used: Photoshop



Work 5

Selected Works

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Idea(s):

Hesse's book inspired me to show reading as quiet self-awakening, like how wind blowing through grass

Materials: photography

Process(es):

Photographing, layer and reorient pictures to show how present moment of nature sparks imagination

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used: Photoshop